Name: _____ **Group:** _____ **Date:** _____

4 ESO · SEASONS & CELEBRATIONS · ROUTE PLUS

Sample exam

✏️ Paper worksheet: do the same activities as on the computer. Write your answers and circle the letter of the right option. Do it without notes the first time.

1 Before the exam: shadowing for the whole unit

A 6-minute review for listening and speaking: sentences from the unit's recordings. Listen, say them out loud, then do it again with no text. The video waits for you.

2 How the exam works

This sample exam has **the same format and the same points as the real exam** (which you will do in a Google Form). 55 minutes, no notes.

1 Listening: 5 questions + listening chart, 5 questions (2 points each)	20
2 Reading: 5 questions + reading log, 5 questions (2 points each)	20
3 Vocabulary: 7 multiple choice (1 point) + 4 gaps (2 points)	15
4 Grammar: 7 multiple choice (1 point) + 4 gaps (2 points)	15
5 Writing: a formal email	30
Total	**100**

All the questions are marked automatically: your **first try** is your score, as in the exam. The email is marked by **ChatGPT** with the exam criteria, which gives you a guide mark. At the end, *My score* shows your total.

⚠️ ChatGPT can make mistakes: its mark is only a guide. In the real exam, your teacher marks the email.

3 Listening: Two New Years

Listen twice to Callum and Yuki talking about their New Year, and answer.

🎧 **Two New Years: Callum and Yuki** · If you cannot listen to it, read transcript 1 at the end of the worksheet (twice, as if you were listening).

1. Why does Callum laugh when he says "Nobody knows all the words"? [2 points]
   a) It's funny that everyone sings a song they don't fully know. **b)** He thinks the song is too long.
   c) He doesn't like the song. **d)** He forgot the words himself.
2. How is Yuki's New Year different from Callum's? [2 points]
   a) It is mainly about fireworks. **b)** It is bigger than Christmas. **c)** It takes place in the street.
   d) It is quiet, not like a party.
3. How does Yuki sound at the end? [2 points]
   a) angry **b)** excited **c)** worried **d)** calm and thoughtful
4. What does Callum value most? [2 points]
   a) the fireworks **b)** feeling that the whole street is one big family **c)** the presents **d)** the food

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5. What does Yuki mean by “you leave the problems of the old year behind”? [2 points]

   a) You should forget your old friends. **b)** New Year is a fresh start. **c)** Problems are only for adults.

   d) Her family moves house every year.

4 Listening chart

Listen again if you need to. What does each speaker value, and how do you know? Think about their words and their tone of voice.

🎧 **Two New Years: Callum and Yuki** · If you cannot listen to it, read transcript 1 at the end of the worksheet (twice, as if you were listening).

6. Which detail best shows how much neighbours matter at Hogmanay? [2 points]

   a) After midnight, people visit their neighbours to be the first visitor of the year.

   b) People wear about three jumpers because it is freezing. **c)** There are concerts in the city centre.

   d) There are fireworks over the castle at midnight.

7. Which detail best shows that Yuki values her family? [2 points]

   a) She says New Year is a time to thank your family for everything.

   b) She says the temple bells ring 108 times. **c)** She says schools close for several days.

   d) She says the cards all arrive on the same morning.

8. How does Callum’s tone support what he says? [2 points]

   a) He sounds bored, which shows he prefers Christmas.

   b) He laughs and sounds cheerful, which matches the party he describes.

   c) He sounds nervous, which shows he is afraid of the cold.

   d) He sounds calm and serious, which shows Hogmanay is a quiet holiday.

9. What do Callum and Yuki have in common? [2 points]

   a) Both think New Year is less important than Christmas. **b)** Both celebrate with a big street party.

   c) For both, New Year is about the people around them: neighbours for Callum, family for Yuki.

   d) Both get money in small envelopes.

10. Which detail best supports Yuki’s idea of a fresh start? [2 points]

    a) Children get money in small envelopes. **b)** Schools and offices close for several days.

    c) Her mother and grandmother cook for days. **d)** Her family cleans the whole house on 31 December.

5 Reading: Two winter traditions

Read and answer, without notes.

In Catalonia, many families have a Caga Tió at Christmas, a tradition which is thought to date back to old winter celebrations in the countryside. It is a small log with a face, a red hat and a blanket. From 8 December, children “feed” it every night and keep it warm. On Christmas Eve or Christmas Day, they hit it with sticks while they sing a traditional song, and the log “gives” them sweets and small presents.

In the UK and many other countries, children have an Advent calendar, which counts down the days until Christmas. It has 24 small doors, and children open one every day from 1 December. Behind each door there is a picture or a piece of chocolate. Advent calendars used to have only pictures, but today many contain chocolate, small toys or even beauty products for adults. Some people think this shows how commercialised Christmas has become, while others say it simply shows that traditions evolve.

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11. Where does the Caga Tió probably come from? [2 points]

a) Advent calendars **b)** a modern TV advert **c)** old winter celebrations in the countryside **d)** the UK

12. What does an Advent calendar count down? [2 points]

a) the presents a child gets **b)** the hours of Christmas Eve **c)** the days until Christmas **d)** the weeks of winter

13. What is new in some Advent calendars today? [2 points]

a) beauty products for adults **b)** pictures **c)** 24 small doors **d)** handmade wooden doors

14. What do some people think the changes show? [2 points]

a) how commercialised Christmas has become **b)** that traditions never change **c)** that children don't like chocolate **d)** that Christmas is less popular

15. Which tradition has changed more over time, according to the text? [2 points]

a) neither of them **b)** the Advent calendar **c)** the Caga Tió **d)** both equally

6 Reading log

Choose the correct note for each tradition, then the main customs and the meaning of a word from its context. You can look at the text again.

In Catalonia, many families have a Caga Tió at Christmas, a tradition which is thought to date back to old winter celebrations in the countryside. It is a small log with a face, a red hat and a blanket. From 8 December, children "feed" it every night and keep it warm. On Christmas Eve or Christmas Day, they hit it with sticks while they sing a traditional song, and the log "gives" them sweets and small presents.

In the UK and many other countries, children have an Advent calendar, which counts down the days until Christmas. It has 24 small doors, and children open one every day from 1 December. Behind each door there is a picture or a piece of chocolate. Advent calendars used to have only pictures, but today many contain chocolate, small toys or even beauty products for adults. Some people think this shows how commercialised Christmas has become, while others say it simply shows that traditions evolve.

16. Which is the most accurate note about the Caga Tió? [2 points]

a) What: a log that "gives" children sweets, probably from old winter celebrations · When: from 8 December to Christmas · Where: Catalonia

b) What: a log that "gives" adults beauty products · When: from 8 December to Christmas · Where: Catalonia

c) What: a log that "gives" children sweets, probably from old winter celebrations · When: only on 8 December · Where: Catalonia

d) What: a log that "gives" children sweets, invented in the UK · When: from 8 December to Christmas · Where: Catalonia

17. Which is the most accurate note about the Advent calendar? [2 points]

a) What: a calendar that counts down to Christmas, now often commercial · When: from 1 December · Where: the UK and many other countries

b) What: a calendar that counts down to the New Year, now often commercial · When: from 1 December · Where: the UK and many other countries

c) What: a calendar that counts down to Christmas, now often commercial · When: from 8 December · Where: the UK and many other countries

d) What: a calendar that counts down to Christmas, now with only pictures · When: from 1 December · Where: the UK and many other countries

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18. Which are the two main customs of the Caga Tió? [2 points]

a) carrying the log around the village in a parade

b) feeding and warming the log every night, then hitting it with sticks while singing

c) opening a door every day and finding a picture **d)** buying beauty products for adults

19. Which are the main customs of the Advent calendar? [2 points]

a) hitting it with sticks while singing **b)** feeding it every night and keeping it warm

c) opening one door a day from 1 December and finding a picture or a treat

d) hiding it until Christmas Eve

20. The text says the log “gives” children sweets. Why is “gives” in quotation marks? [2 points]

a) Because the log can’t really give anything: adults put the sweets there.

b) Because the children give the sweets to the log. **c)** Because it is a Catalan word.

d) Because the sweets are a secret from the adults.

7 Vocabulary

Choose the right option (1 point), then write the missing word (2 points).

21. Some old traditions might ___ out if young people lose interest. [1 point]

a) go **b)** fall **c)** pass **d)** die

22. Halloween is known ___ costumes and pumpkins. [1 point]

a) for **b)** with **c)** as **d)** by

23. Many customs ___ from old harvest festivals. [1 point]

a) consist **b)** belong **c)** come **d)** depend

24. We should never take our traditions for ___. [1 point]

a) sure **b)** granted **c)** given **d)** real

25. Young people can help keep a tradition ___. [1 point]

a) alive **b)** live **c)** living **d)** life

26. I would ___ it if you could reply by Friday. [1 point]

a) appreciate **b)** propose **c)** thank **d)** ensure

27. Traditions ___ over time: they change and adapt. [1 point]

a) commemorate **b)** evolve **c)** honour **d)** celebrate

28. Lighting candles is an old r_____ in many religions. [2 points]

29. Every student can contribute _____ the event. [2 points]

30. We would appreciate the o_____ to present our project. [2 points]

31. We need to c_____ the needs of every family. [2 points]

8 Grammar

Choose the right option (1 point), then write the missing words (2 points). Contractions are accepted.

32. The Caga Tió, ___ is a Catalan tradition, is popular with children. [1 point]

a) that **b)** which **c)** what **d)** who

33. Sweets ___ to children on Christmas Day. [1 point]

a) are giving **b)** is given **c)** are given **d)** give

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34. ___ Diwali is a Hindu festival, people of other faiths enjoy it too. [1 point]
a) However **b)** Unlike **c)** Despite **d)** Although

35. We look forward to ___ you at the fair. [1 point]
a) see **b)** seen **c)** seeing **d)** to see

36. Abraham Lincoln, ___ was president in 1863, made Thanksgiving official. [1 point]
a) that **b)** whose **c)** which **d)** who

37. Advent calendars are popular. ___, some people think they are too commercial. [1 point]
a) Whereas **b)** Because **c)** Although **d)** On the other hand

38. Diwali, ___ is known as the festival of lights, takes place in autumn. [1 point]
a) that **b)** who **c)** what **d)** which

39. Chestnuts _____ _____ (roast) in the streets in autumn. (passive) [2 points]

40. People _____ _____ _____ (not / use to) buy Advent calendars with toys. [2 points]

41. I would be grateful if you _____ (can) reply soon. [2 points]

42. Hogmanay is the night _____ people go first-footing. [2 points]

9 43. Writing: a formal email

Write without notes, as in the exam.

Your task [30 points]
The community centre in your town is preparing an International New Year evening for families on Friday 8 January. Write a formal email (140–180 words) to Mr Jordi Serra, the director, proposing an activity about a New Year tradition from another country. Write it in paragraphs: why you are writing, your plan (which tradition, what families will do and why it matters), one polite request, and a formal closing. Mr Serra is worried that the hall is small and the evening could be too crowded: answer this concern in your email.

The community centre in the student's town is preparing an International New Year evening for families on Friday 8 January. The class wants to run an activity about a New Year tradition from another country. The email is to Mr Jordi Serra, the director of the community centre.

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Transcripts (only if you cannot listen)

Transcript 1 · Two New Years: Callum and Yuki

Callum: [cheerful] Hi, I’m Callum, from Edinburgh in Scotland. In Scotland, New Year’s Eve is called Hogmanay, and for us it’s bigger than Christmas! There’s a huge street party in the city centre, with concerts and fireworks over the castle at midnight. It’s usually freezing, so you wear about three jumpers. [laughs]

Callum: Then everyone holds hands and sings an old song, “Auld Lang Syne”. [laughs] Nobody knows all the words! It’s a song about old friends and remembering the good times. After midnight, we go “first-footing”: you visit your neighbours and you’re the first person to walk into their house in the new year.

Callum: You bring a small present, like shortbread or a piece of coal for the fire. My gran says the first visitor brings luck for the whole year, so she always makes sure a friendly neighbour comes first. Last year I was our neighbours’ first visitor, and they gave me a huge slice of cake. What I love is that the whole street feels like one big family.

Yuki: [calm] Hello, I’m Yuki, and I’m from Osaka in Japan. New Year, or Shōgatsu, is the most important holiday of the year for my family. Schools and many offices close for several days, and lots of people travel home to their parents’ houses. [thoughtful] It’s quite quiet, not like a party.

Yuki: On the thirty-first of December, we clean the whole house, so we can start the year fresh. In the evening we eat long noodles, because they mean a long life. At midnight, temple bells ring one hundred and eight times. On the first of January, we eat special food that my mother and grandmother cook for days, and we visit a shrine to pray for a good year. Children get money in small envelopes.

Yuki: We also send New Year cards to our friends and teachers, and they all arrive on the same morning. [softly] For me, New Year is about starting again. You leave the problems of the old year behind, and you thank your family for everything.

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